The Relaxation of Australia

At the start of the 1960s, Australia became entangled with the revolutionary movement. With the vast number of ethnic groups in the country, Australia experienced a shift in social attitude as well as various political changes. In 1967, a vote was cast to determine the voting rights that would be given to the Aborigines as citizens of the country. Majority of the population voted yes and new laws were created in favor of the Aborigines. Because there was opposition to some of these new policies, there were protests carried out by both Australians and the Aborigines.

Led by Gough Whitlam, the Australian Labor Party was voted to power in 1972, which meant that the Liberal and Country Party had to step down from power. The new party stopped enrollment and made health care free within the following three years. Australian policies that negatively impacted the Aborigines were repealed to pave a new way forward. Furthermore, university was made free, women were given the same salaries as men, ethnic diversity was welcomed and no-fault divorces were granted to the people.

Despite these great reforms, the Governor General toppled the new government by exposing corrupt scandals in the government. When the next general election came around, the Labor Party was utterly defeated and replaced by the Liberal-National Coalition until the mid-1980s.

Australia and the Sea

The Australian National Anthem declares that ‘our home is girt by sea’ which translates to ‘our home is surrounded by sea’. This is a reminder about the life that lives in the sea. In the centuries before European settlement, northern Australia had maritime connections with the Macassan trepang fishery for the Chinese market. Boats from Java and other parts of Indonesia occasionally touched at Australian shores to trade with the Aborigines. The Aboriginal population mainly concentrated on land resources even though small craft was used for fishing or local transport. Australia’s maritime development came gradually with European settlement. Its beginnings can be traced back to 1788 with the settling of a